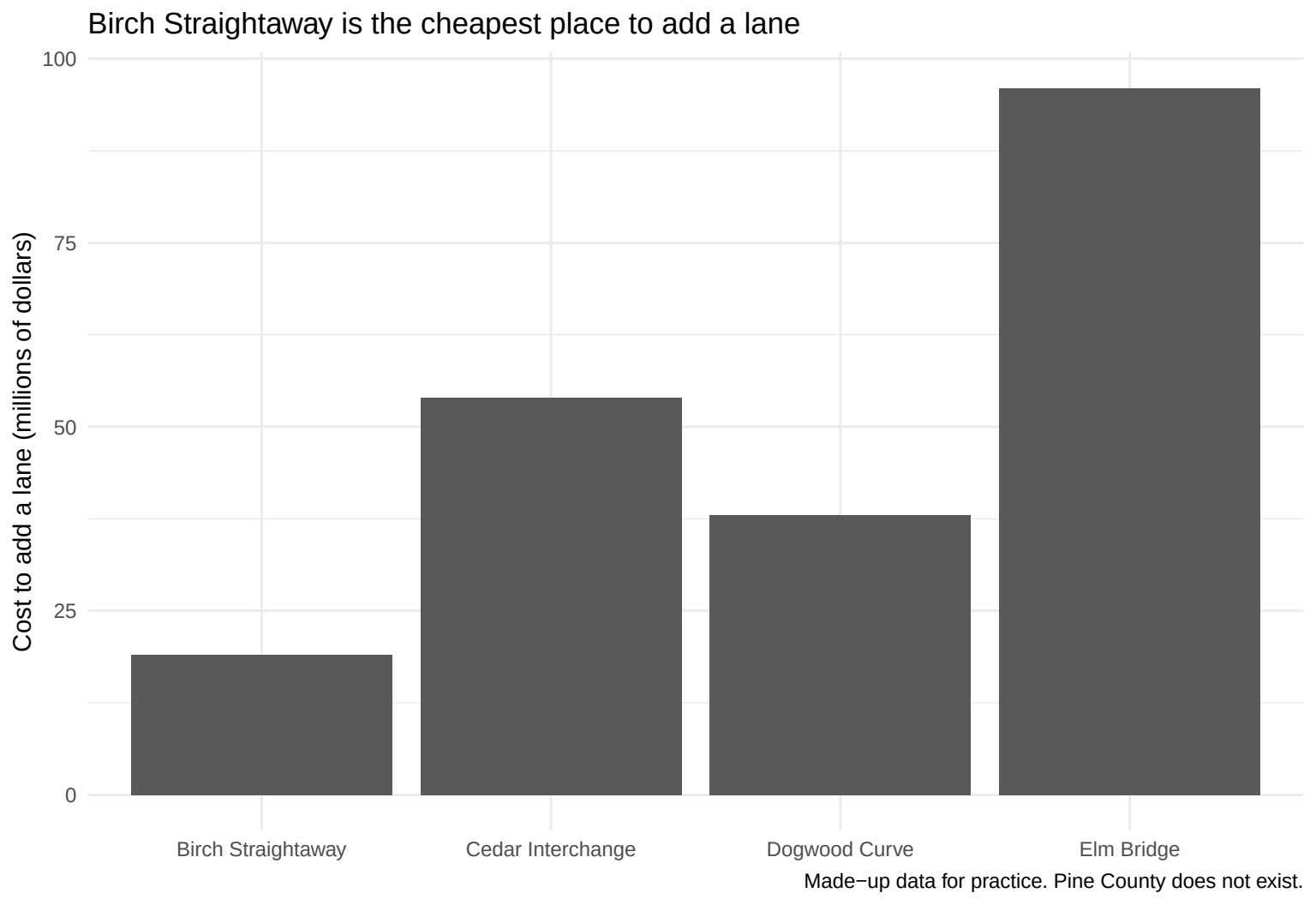
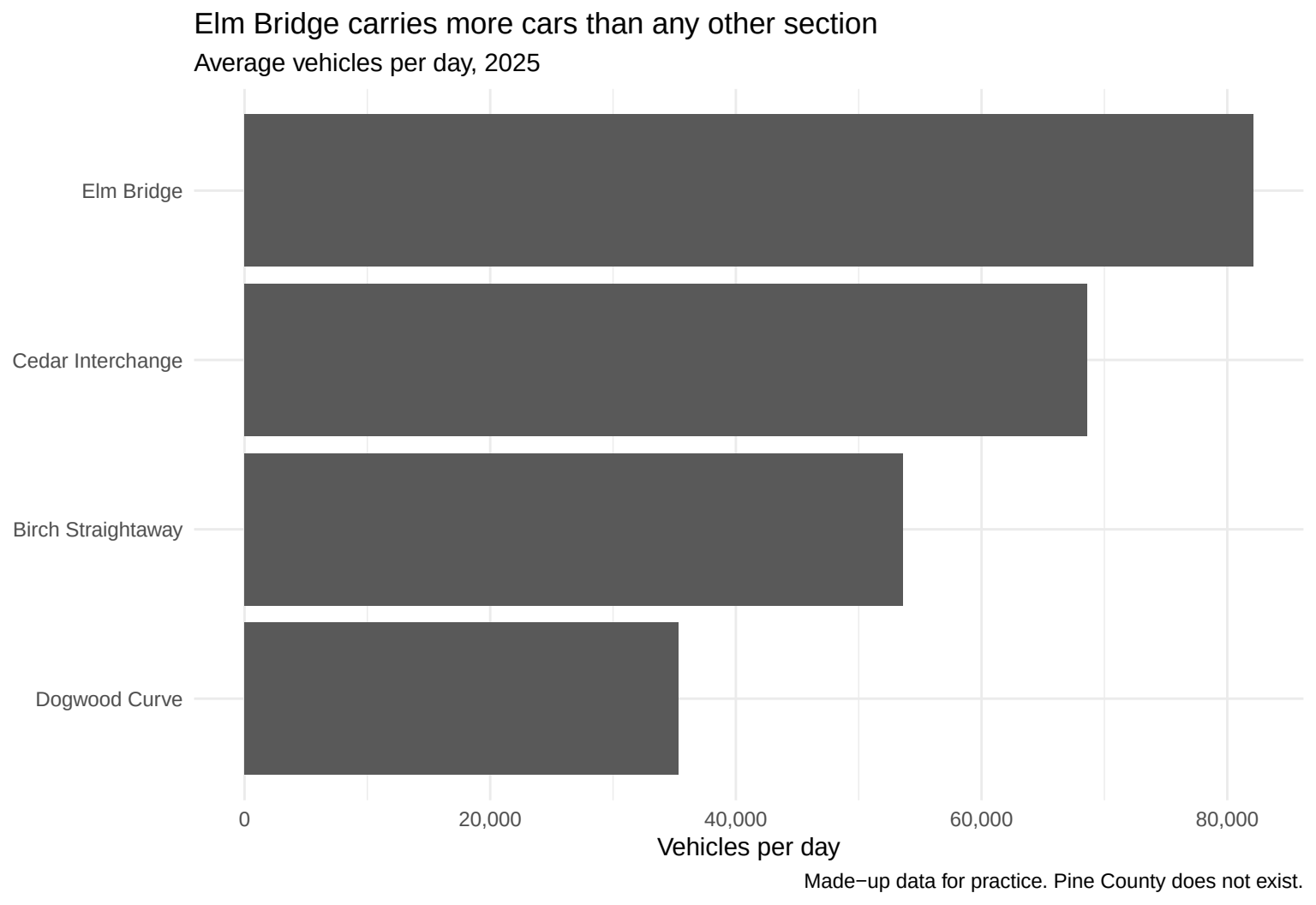
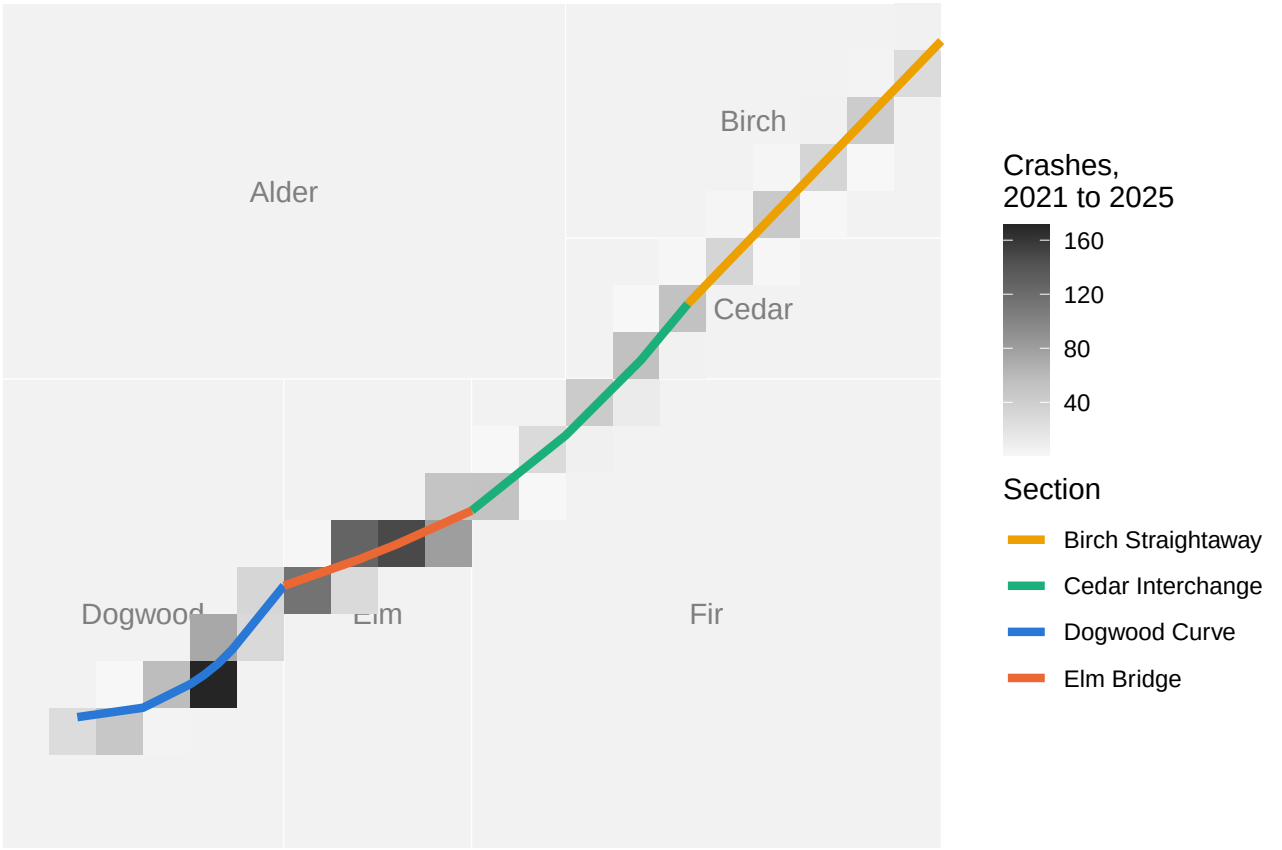

Birch Straightaway is the cheapest place to add a lane
Cost to add a lane (millions of dollars)
100
75
50
25
0
Birch Straightaway
Cedar Interchange
Dogwood Curve
Elm Bridge
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

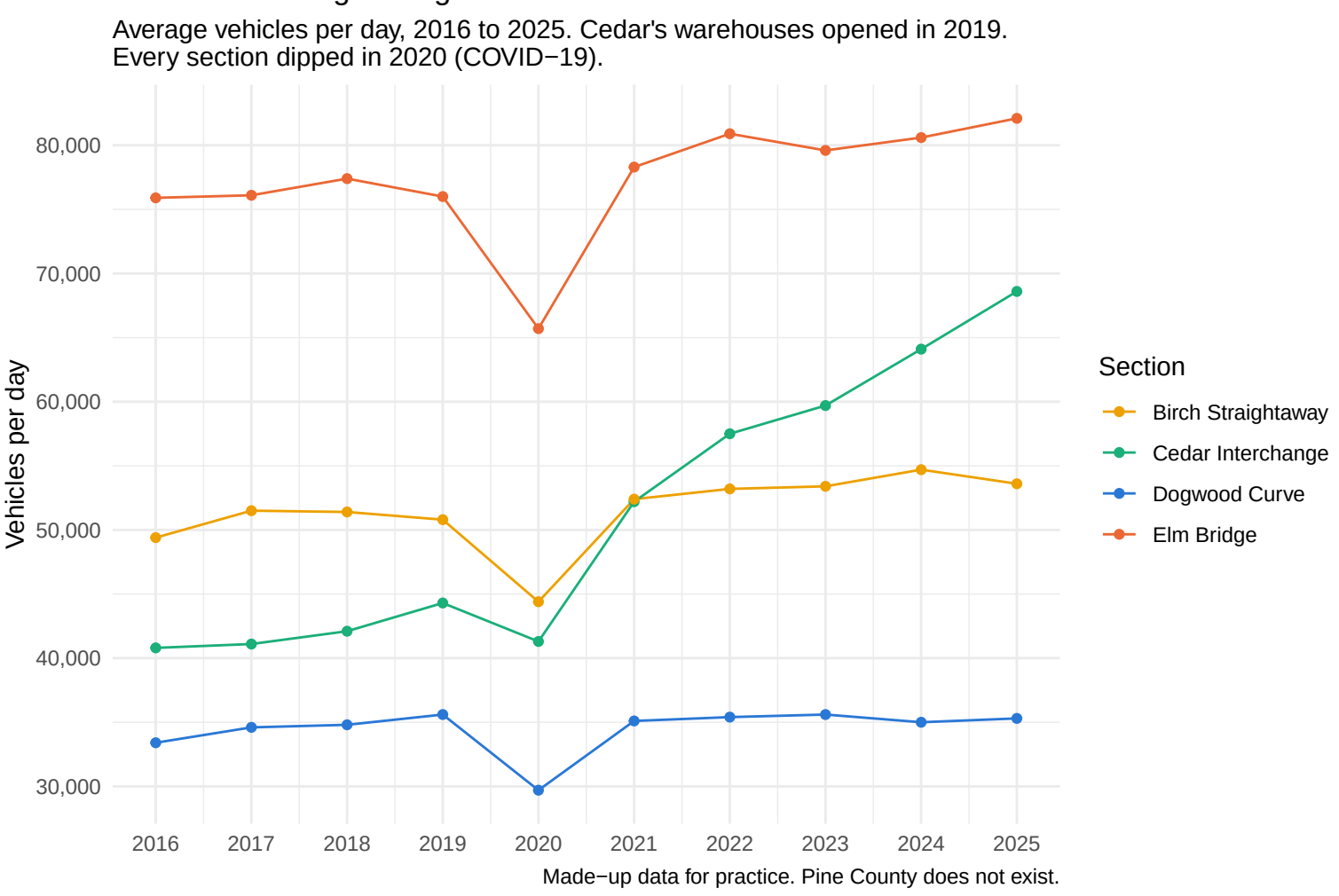

Elm Bridge carries more cars than any other section
Average vehicles per day, 2025
Elm Bridge
Cedar Interchange
Birch Straightaway
Dogwood Curve
0
20,000
40,000
60,000
80,000
Vehicles per day
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

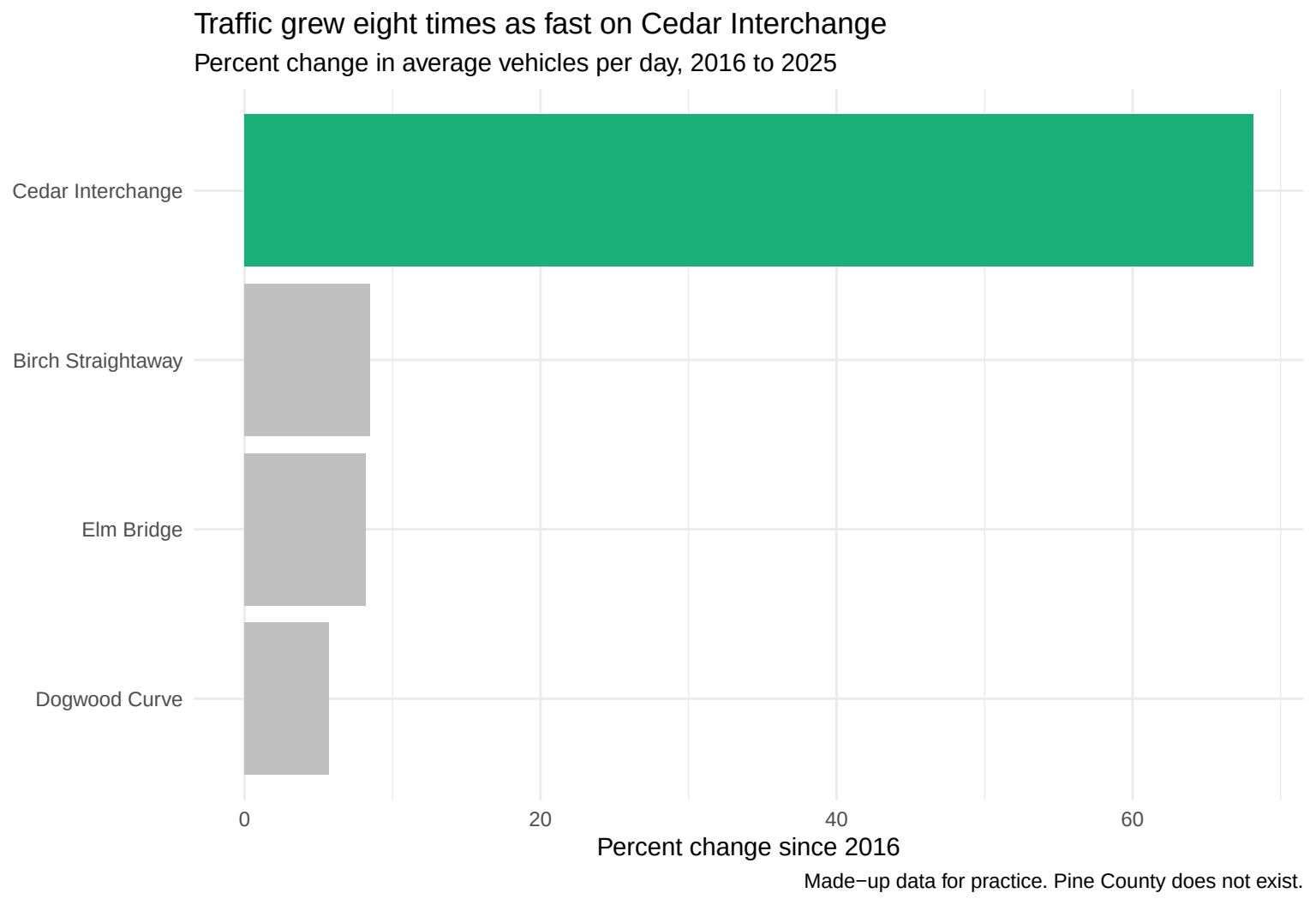
Crashes bunch up on Elm Bridge and the middle of Dogwood Curve

Each square is half a mile on a side. The darker the square, the more crashes in it.



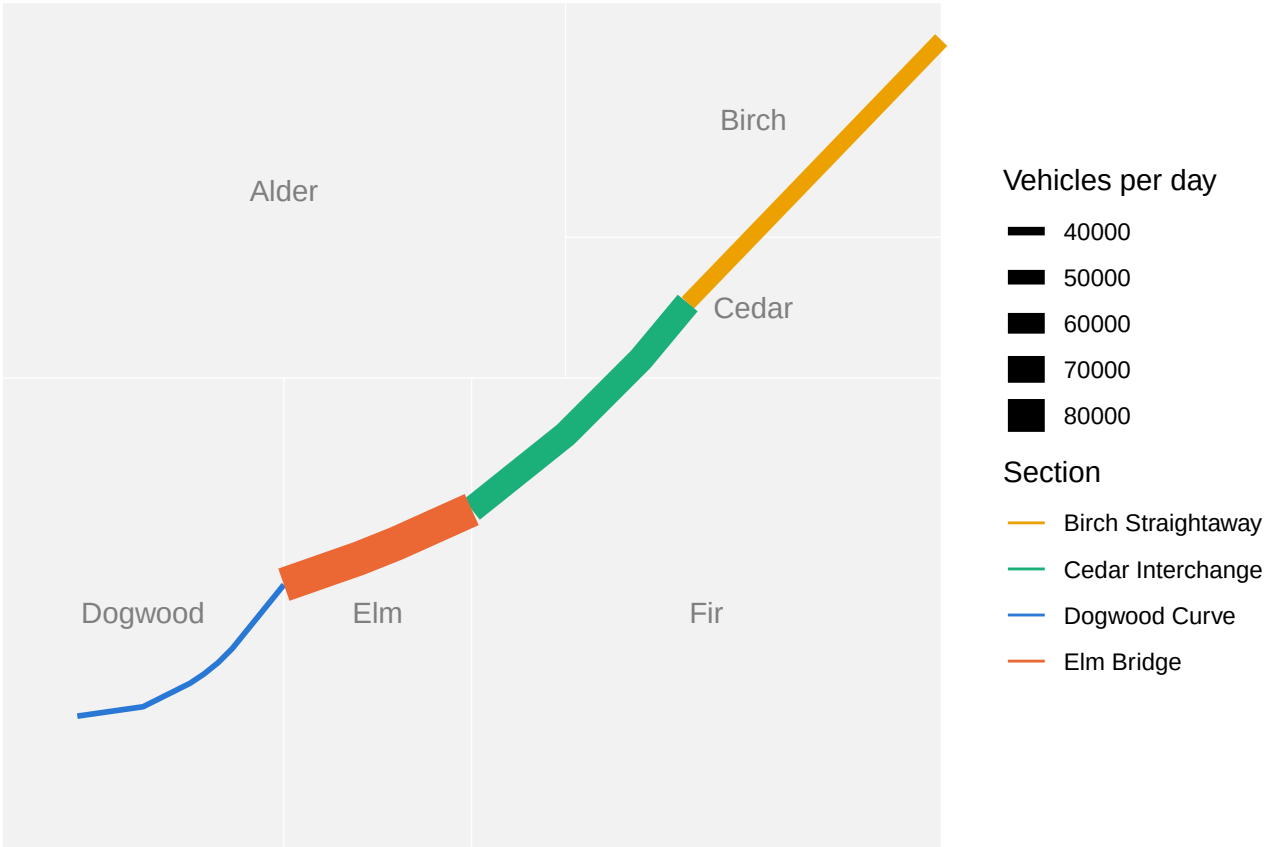
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.


Cedar Interchange has gained the most cars since 2019
Average vehicles per day, 2016 to 2025. Cedar's warehouses opened in 2019.
Every section dipped in 2020 (COVID−19).
Vehicles per day
80,000
70,000
60,000
50,000
40,000
30,000
2016
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.
Section
Birch Straightaway
Cedar Interchange
Dogwood Curve
Elm Bridge


Traffic grew eight times as fast on Cedar Interchange
Percent change in average vehicles per day, 2016 to 2025
Cedar Interchange
Birch Straightaway
Elm Bridge
Dogwood Curve
0
20
40
60
Percent change since 2016
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

Elm Bridge carries more cars than any other section

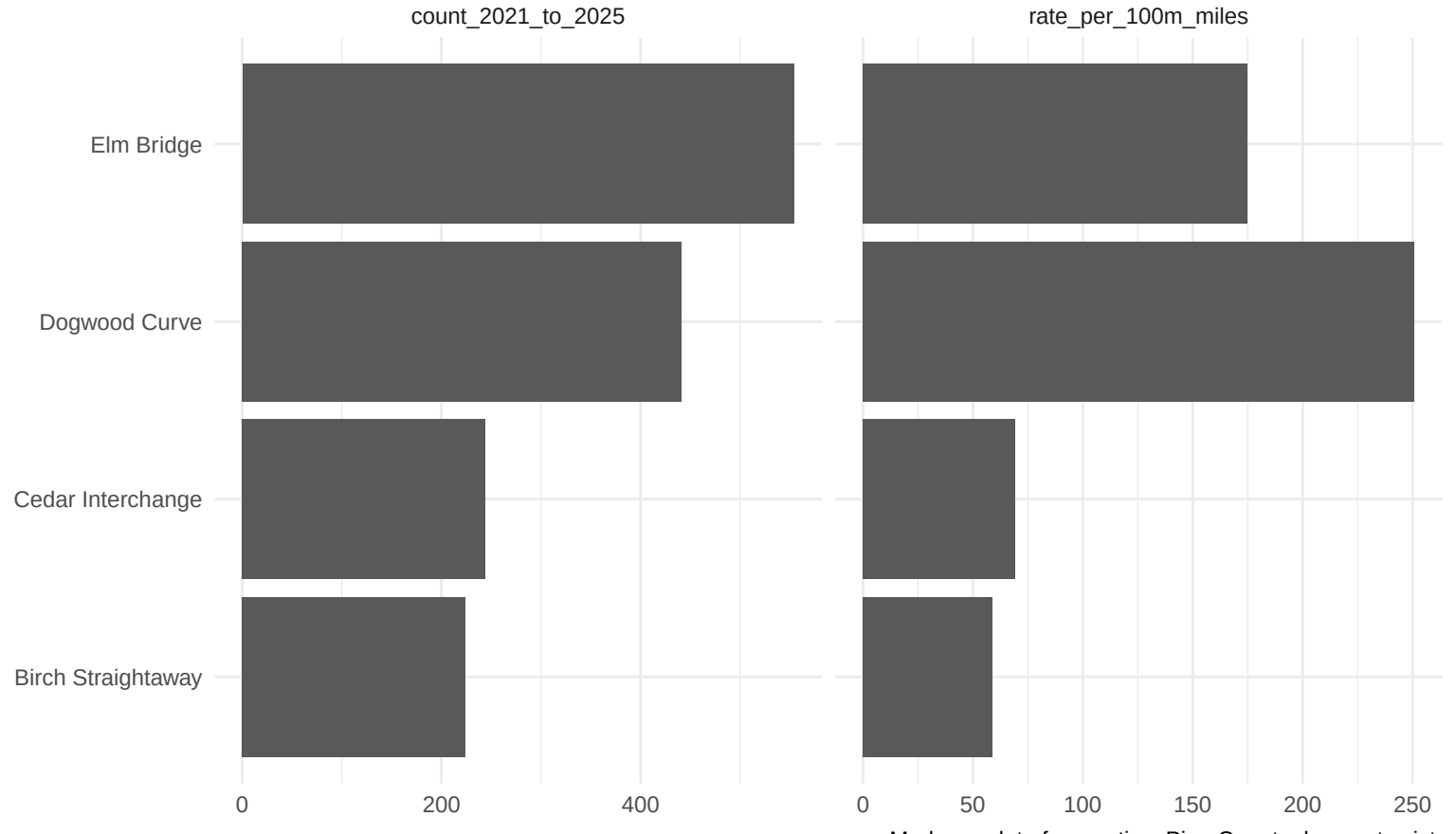
Average vehicles per day in 2025. The thicker the line, the more traffic.



Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

Elm Bridge has the most crashes, but Dogwood Curve has the highest rate

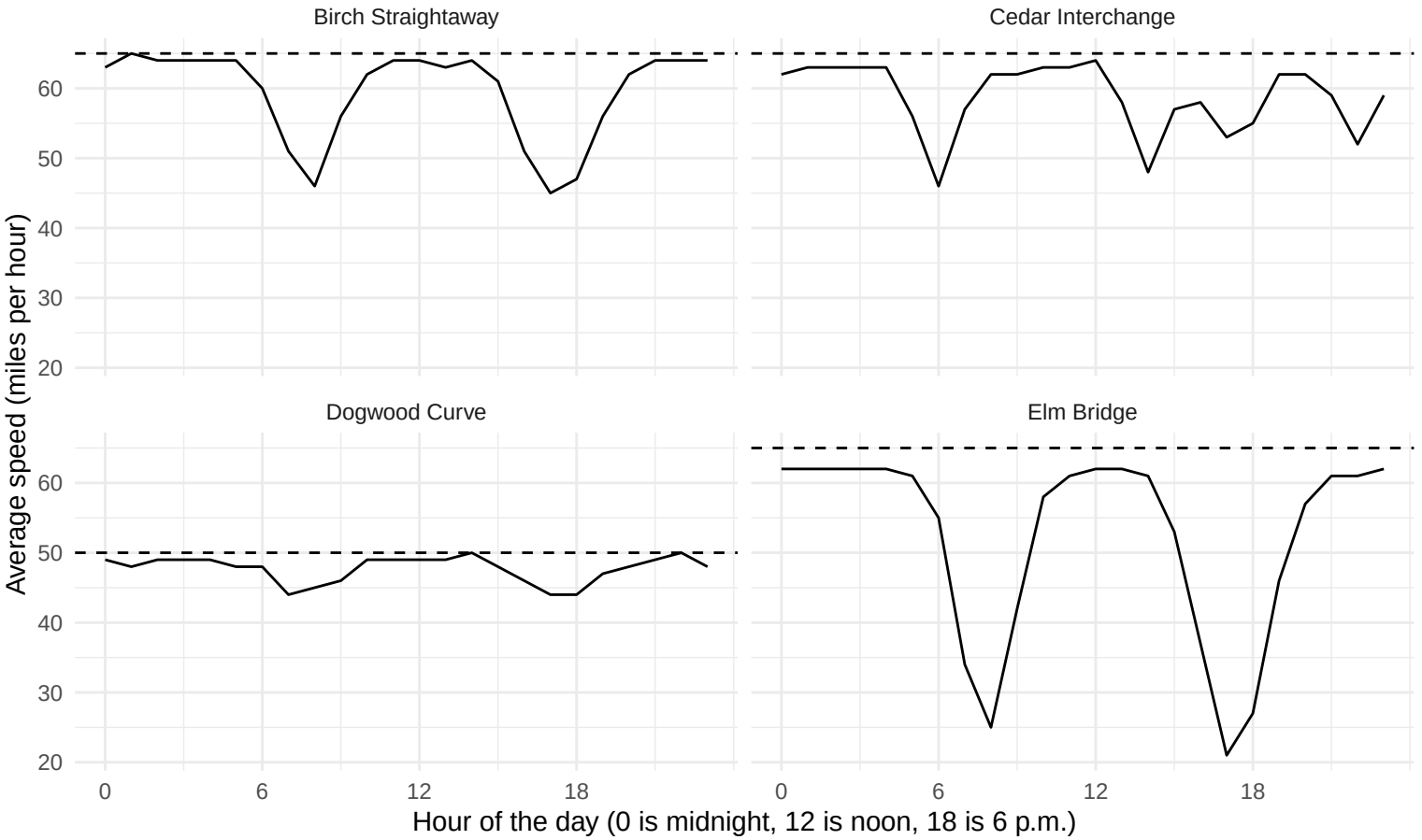
Left: crashes, 2021 to 2025. Right: crashes per 100 million miles driven.
A rate divides by how much driving happens there.



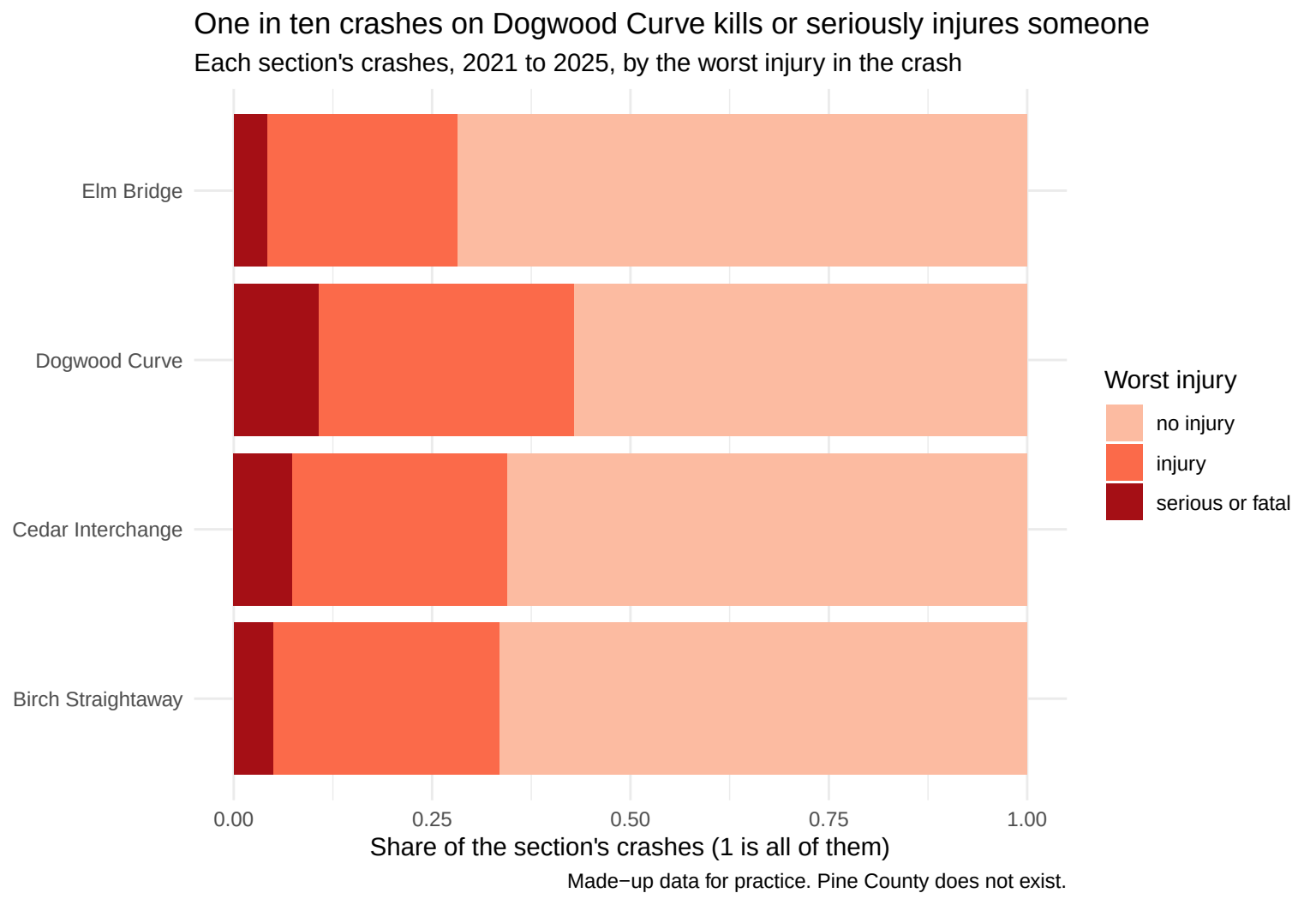
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

At the evening rush, cars on Elm Bridge crawl at about 20 mph

Average speed on a weekday in 2025, hour by hour. Dashed line: the speed limit.

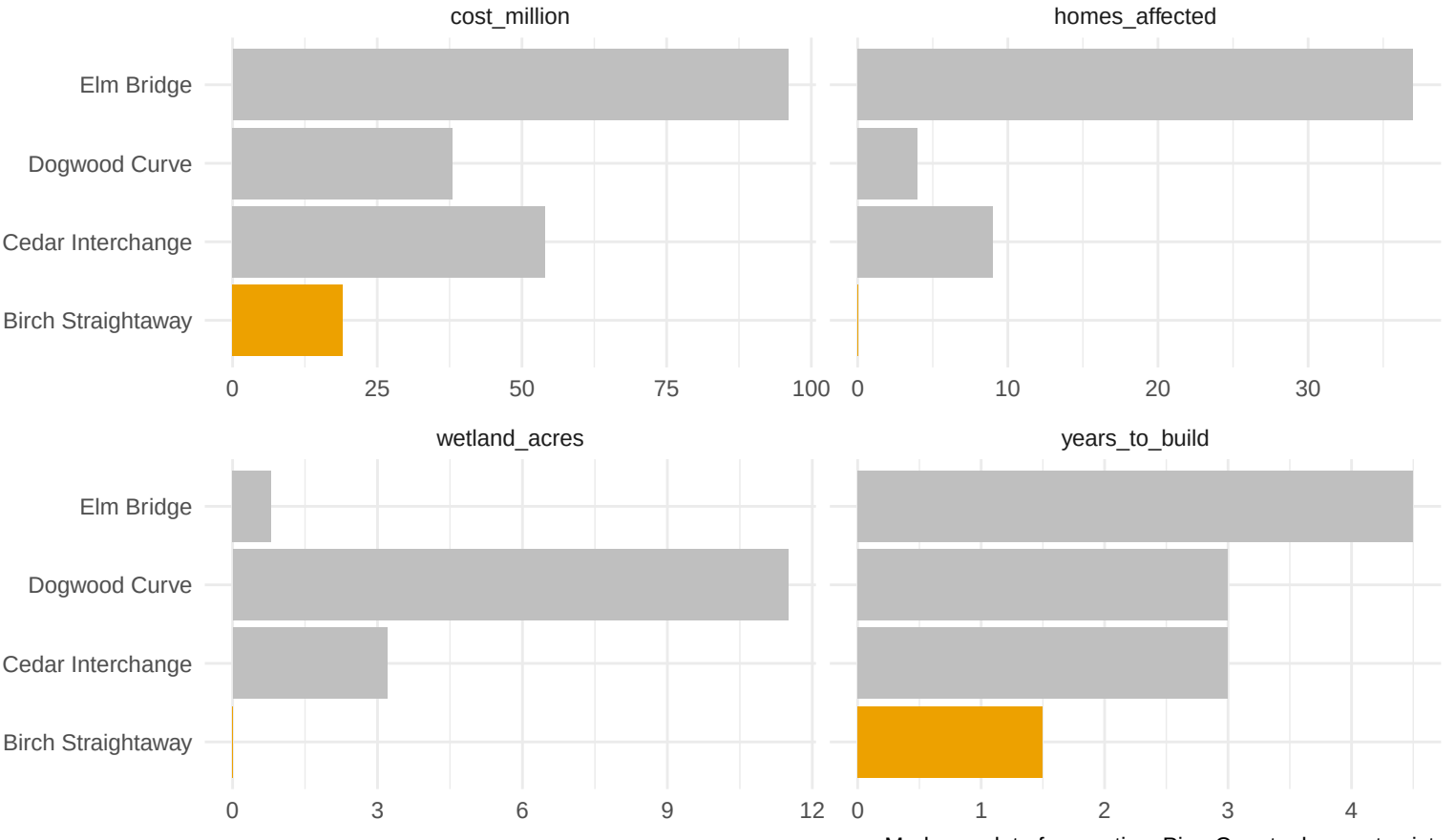


Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.


One in ten crashes on Dogwood Curve kills or seriously injures someone
Each section's crashes, 2021 to 2025, by the worst injury in the crash
Elm Bridge
Dogwood Curve
Cedar Interchange
Birch Straightaway
0.00
0.25
0.50
0.75
1.00
Share of the section's crashes (1 is all of them)
Worst injury
no injury
injury
serious or fatal
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

Birch Straightaway costs the least in every way

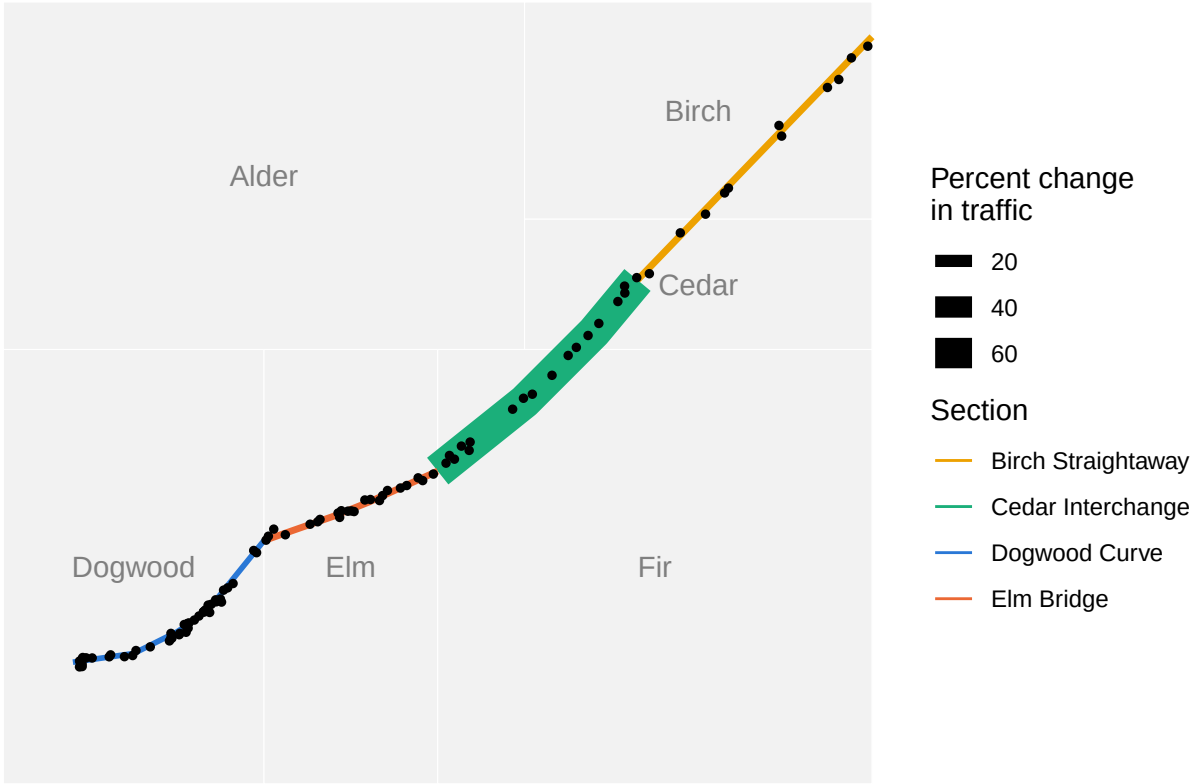
What adding a lane would take: dollars (millions), homes, wetland acres, and years. Shorter bars are better.



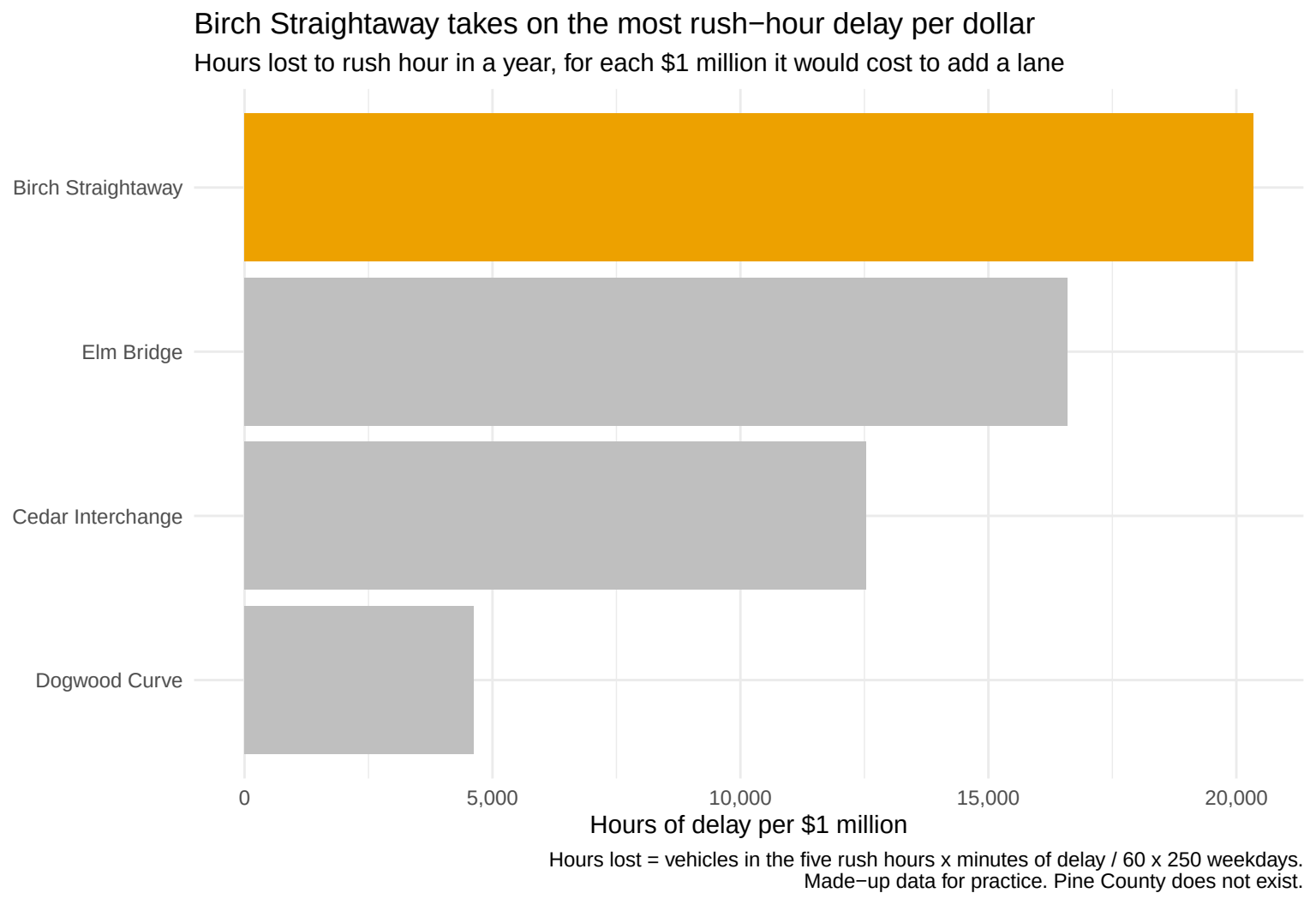
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

Traffic grew fastest on Cedar Interchange, but serious crashes bunch up on Dogwood Curve

The thicker the line, the more its traffic grew, 2016 to 2025.
Each black dot is a serious or fatal crash, 2021 to 2025.

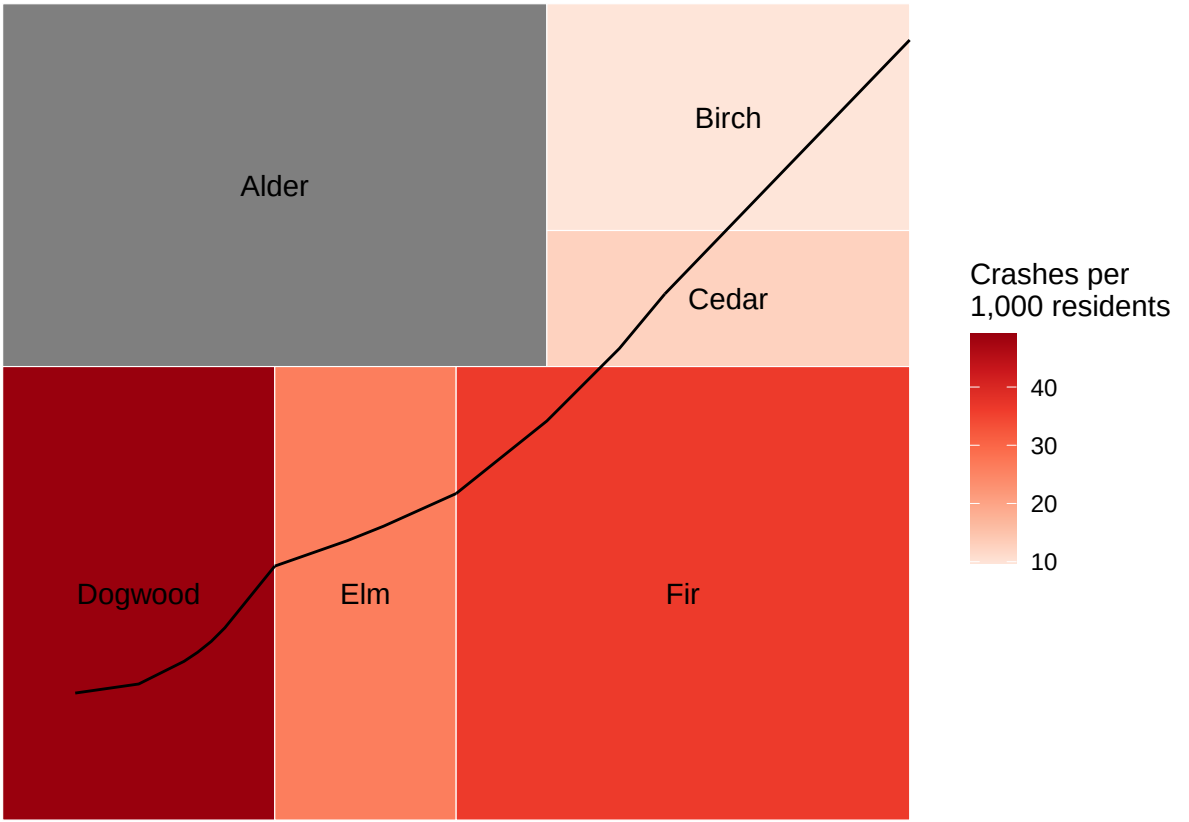


Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.


Birch Straightaway takes on the most rush−hour delay per dollar
Hours lost to rush hour in a year, for each $1 million it would cost to add a lane
Birch Straightaway
Elm Bridge
Cedar Interchange
Dogwood Curve
0
5,000
10,000
15,000
20,000
Hours of delay per $1 million
Hours lost = vehicles in the five rush hours x minutes of delay / 60 x 250 weekdays.
Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.

For the people who live there, Dogwood has the most Parkway crashes

Each town's Parkway crashes, 2021 to 2025, per 1,000 residents. The black line is the Parkway. Alder (grey) has no Parkway, so it has no Parkway crashes.



Made−up data for practice. Pine County does not exist.